Activity: Navigating and Creating Files Using Command Line

Aim

Learners will use basic command line commands to view folders, move between directories, create a new folder, and create a text file.

Duration

20–30 minutes (online or classroom).

Step-by-Step Learner Task

- Part 1 – View the Working Directory:
  Open Command Prompt, type 'dir', and observe the list of files and folders.
  Question: What does the 'dir' command show?
  Ans: It shows a list of files and folders that are immediately one level below the current folder.
- Part 2 – Create a New Folder:
  Type 'mkdir BootcampPractice' and then 'dir' to confirm creation.
  Question: Which command creates a new directory?
  Ans: mkdir
- Part 3 – Move Into the Folder:
  Type 'cd BootcampPractice' and then 'dir' to confirm you are inside.
  Question: What does the 'cd' command do?
  Ans: cd moves the cmd to the specified file directory.
- Part 4 – Create a Text File:
  Type 'notepad notes.txt', write 'My first command line file.', save, close, then type 'dir' to confirm.
  Question: Which command creates and opens a new file?
  Ans: notepad

Challenge Task

Create the structure BootcampPractice → Tasks → task1.txt using command line commands only.

```
Command Prompt

04/02/2026  14:13    <DIR>          ..
04/02/2026  13:48    <DIR>          Skills Bootcamp Practice
               0 File(s)              0 bytes
               3 Dir(s)  310,303,481,856 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>cd "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>mkdir BootcampPractice

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>cd BootcampPractice

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice>mkdir Tasks

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice>cd Tasks

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>notepad task1.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>dir
 Volume in drive C is Windows
 Volume Serial Number is AC65-71AF

 Directory of C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks

04/02/2026  14:14    <DIR>          .
04/02/2026  14:14    <DIR>          ..
04/02/2026  14:14                 0 task1.txt
               1 File(s)              0 bytes
               2 Dir(s)  310,268,854,272 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>
```

Assessment Evidence

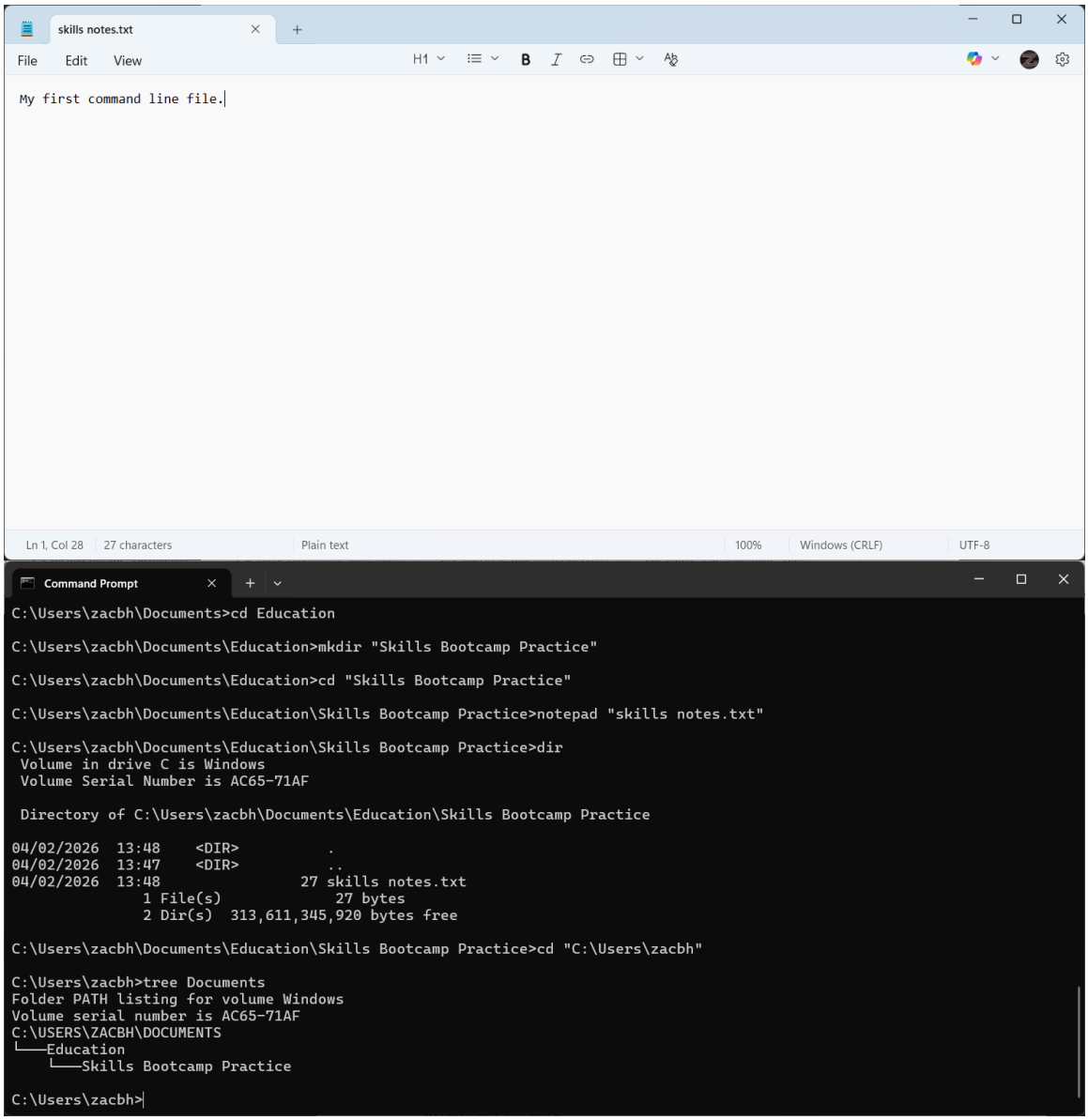
Provide a screenshot of Command Prompt showing commands used and confirm the notes.txt file exists inside BootcampPractice.

Command Prompt

```
            in addition to the directory itself.  Used to remove a directory
            tree.

    /Q      Quiet mode, do not ask if ok to remove a directory tree with /S

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>rmdir /S Education
Education, Are you sure (Y/N)? Y

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>dir
 Volume in drive C is Windows
 Volume Serial Number is AC65-71AF

 Directory of C:\Users\zacbh\Documents

04/02/2026  13:47    <DIR>          .
04/02/2026  13:25    <DIR>          ..
               0 File(s)              0 bytes
               2 Dir(s)  313,623,281,664 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>mkdir Education

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>cd Education

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>mkdir "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>cd "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>notepad "skills notes.txt"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>
```

Command Prompt

```
 Directory of C:\Users\zacbh\Documents

04/02/2026  13:47    <DIR>          .
04/02/2026  13:25    <DIR>          ..
               0 File(s)              0 bytes
               2 Dir(s)  313,623,281,664 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>mkdir Education

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents>cd Education

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>mkdir "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>cd "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>notepad "skills notes.txt"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>dir
 Volume in drive C is Windows
 Volume Serial Number is AC65-71AF

 Directory of C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice

04/02/2026  13:48    <DIR>          .
04/02/2026  13:47    <DIR>          ..
04/02/2026  13:48                27 skills notes.txt
               1 File(s)             27 bytes
               2 Dir(s)  313,611,345,920 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>
```



Success Criteria

- List files using 'dir'.
- Create folders using 'mkdir'.
- Navigate using 'cd'.
- Create files using 'notepad'.

Task 1 - Evidence

```
Command Prompt

04/02/2026  14:13    <DIR>          ..
04/02/2026  13:48    <DIR>          Skills Bootcamp Practice
               0 File(s)              0 bytes
               3 Dir(s)  310,303,481,856 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education>cd "Skills Bootcamp Practice"

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>mkdir BootcampPractice

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice>cd BootcampPractice

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice>mkdir Tasks

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice>cd Tasks

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>notepad task1.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>dir
 Volume in drive C is Windows
 Volume Serial Number is AC65-71AF

 Directory of C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks

04/02/2026  14:14    <DIR>          .
04/02/2026  14:14    <DIR>          ..
04/02/2026  14:14                 0 task1.txt
               1 File(s)              0 bytes
               2 Dir(s)  310,268,854,272 bytes free

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\Skills Bootcamp Practice\BootcampPractice\Tasks>
```

Task 2 - Evidence

```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git rm --help

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>notepad example.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git add example.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>notepad example.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git diff
diff --git a/example.txt b/example.txt
index 9e8a09e..df1e795 100644
--- a/example.txt
+++ b/example.txt
@@ -1 +1,2 @@
-- Milk
\ No newline at end of file
+- Milk
+- Bread
\ No newline at end of file

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git add example.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git commit --help

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git commit -m "Initial commit"
[master (root-commit) c1a35c0] Initial commit
 1 file changed, 2 insertions(+)
 create mode 100644 example.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>git log
commit c1a35c0ceff8cf4a1b9180485d278670dca67dd9 (HEAD -> master)
Author: Zachary Bhumgara <zacbhumgara+githublaptop@gmail.com>
Date:   Wed Feb 4 15:24:52 2026 +0000

    Initial commit

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>
```

Task 3 - Evidence

```
Command Prompt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task2>cd C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Edu
cation\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks>mkdir Task3

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks>cd Task3

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3>mkdir hamlet-prince-of-denmark

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3>cd hamlet-prince-of-denmark

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3\hamlet-prince-of-denmark>notepa
d scene1.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3\hamlet-prince-of-denmark>git ad
d scene1.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3\hamlet-prince-of-denmark>git co
mmit -m "my hour"
[master (root-commit) ffa3c4b] my hour
 1 file changed, 7 insertions(+)
 create mode 100644 Documents/Education/SkillsBootcamp/BootcampPractice/Tasks/Task3/hamlet-prince-of-denmark/s
cene1.txt

C:\Users\zacbh\Documents\Education\SkillsBootcamp\BootcampPractice\Tasks\Task3\hamlet-prince-of-denmark>
```